



In the Level 5 course, students expand upon their critical abilities in creating masterful writing: discerning research, composing arguments, building theories, and imagining what's missing – all within the context of exploring some of history's most enduring mysteries. Students will gain skills in independent research and source evaluation, experience in text analysis and drafting plausible theories, and foster their emerging expertise in crafting the complex, nuanced writing required in upper-level coursework.

The goal of AoPS Academy Language Arts courses is to train the intellectual leaders of the next generation by fostering creative problem solving. In our classes, students tackle projects that are framed as interpretation and communication problems: how can we communicate an idea in just the right way? Or, how can we understand complex ideas that are being communicated to us? To solve these problems, students must craft written pieces and oral presentations that demonstrate mastery of the Language Arts skills they learned in class. In this way, our courses help students develop the confidence and advanced literacy skills they need to solve any communication problem they encounter, whether it's in college, in the professional world, or in their own lives.

Time Commitment: This 36-week course includes 105 minutes of in-class instruction and 60-90 minutes of homework each week, corresponding to a full-year course.

Homework: Students should expect to spend about 1–2 hours on homework every week. Homework will include practicing the reading, writing, and grammar skills covered in class, working on ongoing writing projects, and completing reading assignments. Students are expected to read independently throughout the year from assigned novels and nonfiction books. Students will take weekly reading quizzes on the course homepage to ensure that they are keeping up with the reading.

Content:

Week	Topic	Week	Topic
1	Unit Introduction & Text Summation	19	Unit Introduction & Informational Writing
2	Source Assessment	20	Citation Formatting
3	Source Reliability	21	Quotation Usage
4	Source Comparison	22	Bibliography Structure
5	Case File Drafting	23	Article Drafting
6	Coordinating Conjunctions	24	Subordinating Conjunctions
7	Correlative Coordinators	25	Prepositional Phrases
8	Writing Workshop & Revisions	26	Writing Workshop & Article Revisions
9	Case File Presentations	27	Article Interview Day
10	Unit Introduction & Persuasive Writing	28	The Secret Society: Unit Introduction
11	Essay Structure	29	Character & Setting
12	Paragraph Structure	30	Story Arc & Mystery
13	Counterpoints & Argument Defense	31	Dialogue & Emotion
14	Research & Introductions	32	Point of View & Drafting
15	Present Perfect & Conclusions	33	Word Choice, Imagery, & Setting
16	Past Perfect & Conditionals	34	Paragraphing & Pacing
17	Writing Workshop & Essay Revisions	35	Writing Workshop & Narrative Revisions
18	Closing Argument Presentations	36	Author Event Day

The course is divided into four project-based units:

Unit	Description	Common Core Standards	Core Skills or Concepts
1 Research Report	Students research and synthesize multiple sources to compile a case file on a famous historical mystery. Book: <i>African Icons</i>	• RI: 5.2, 5.3, 5.6, 5.9 • W 5.2.B, 5.4, 5.5, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9.B, 5.10 • SL 5.4 • L 5.1.A, 5.1.E, 5.2.D, 5.3, 5.4,	• examine non-fiction texts and distill key information • assess sources for reliability • use conjunctive adverbs & coordinators to create formal tone • craft a multi-section research report • revise writing over time & incorporate feedback • present & communicate ideas in a pitch setting
2 Argumentative Writing	Students analyze conflicting evidence to draft an argumentative essay about the sinking of the <i>Titanic</i> . Book: <i>Titanic: Out of Time</i>	• RL 5.6 • RI 5.2, 5.3, 5.6, 5.9 • W 5.1.A, 5.1.B, 5.1.D, 5.4, 5.5, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9.B, 5.10 • SL 5.4 • L 5.1.B, 5.1.C, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4	• examine non-fiction sources to develop a thesis • write conditional sentences for rhetorical effect • craft a multi-paragraph essay • revise writing over time & incorporate feedback • deliver a persuasive speech • present & communicate ideas in a closing argument setting
3 Informative Essay	Students develop a research-based hypothesis about the disappearance of Amelia Earhart and explain it in an informative essay. Book: <i>Amelia Lost</i>	• RI 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.6, 5.9 • W 5.2.A, 5.2.B, C 5.2.E, 5.4, 5.5, 5.7, 5.8, 5.9.B, 5.10 • SL 5.4 • L 5.1.A, 5.2, 5.2.B, 5.3, 5.4	• deduce a theory from a variety of non-fiction sources • deploy prepositional phrases for effect • craft a multi-paragraph informative argument • revise writing over time & incorporate feedback • present & communicate ideas in an interview setting
4 Mystery Narrative	Students examine mysteries through the lens of a writer and craft an original work of fiction on "history's missing mystery." Book: <i>The Wollstonecraft Detective Agency: No. 1</i>	• RL 5.3, 5.5, 5.6 • W 5.3.A, 5.3.B, 5.3.D, 5.3.E, 5.4, 5.5, 5.10 • SL 5.4 • L 5.1.D, 5.2, 5.3.A, 5.4	• Identify and use characterization • develop narrative structure using mystery elements, dialogue, point of view, word choice, and imagery • deploy proper paragraph and pacing to improve narrative flow • craft a multi-paragraph historical fiction mystery narrative • revise writing over time & incorporate feedback • present & communicate ideas in a author reading setting

To interpret the Common Core Standards column on the table above, visit the Common Core ELA website at <https://www.thecorestandards.org/ELA-Literacy/>